Manel Leiva

Senior Product Designer

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SUMMARY

Senior Product Designer with 15 years designing complex digital products and building and maintaining design systems.

Led design-system work across five product squads at Abacum, then built Remuner's system from scratch as sole designer.

Works directly with engineers on component architecture, Figma libraries and variables, design tokens, documentation, governance, and the pipelines connecting design to code.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer

Remuner

May 2024 - Mar 2026 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Built the Figma component library and design system from scratch as sole designer, alongside product work across the full product surface.
- Ran an ongoing product audit: captured existing patterns, defined and documented component variants, states, and behaviors, then worked with engineers to decide when each improvement should ship.
- Owned the design side of the token pipeline; used Codex to add CI validation, drift detection, smoke tests, W3C token output, an HTML preview, and JSON output through engineering-reviewed PRs.
- Ran a monthly governance meeting with engineering to review progress, resolve implementation issues, and keep the system aligned with product priorities.

Senior Product Designer

Abacum

Jan 2022 - Apr 2024 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Worked on the Abax design system alongside product work: Figma variables, a two-tier token architecture, component library, governance, and the Token Studio to Style Dictionary pipeline, adopted across five squads.
- Co-led the design-system business case with the head of design and presented it to engineering leadership; the work was selected for dedicated design and engineering time.
- Ran the weekly design-library sync and structured contribution process; components moved from exploration to the canonical implementation library only after review.
- Created contribution guidelines, naming and deprecation conventions, issue-reporting categories, and the release and migration process for existing product surfaces.

Senior Product Designer & Co-founder

Kings of Mambo

Sep 2010 - Nov 2021 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Co-founded and led a UX studio for 11 years; designed products for media, retail, finance, legal, and culture clients.
- Built much of what I designed, including CMS-connected WordPress themes, front-end component libraries, and a shared starter kit with a build pipeline and CSS variables.
- Taught UX and digital design, including taking a design file through to a working CMS-driven site.

SKILLS

Design systems: Component architecture, Figma libraries and variables, design tokens, governance, contribution models, documentation, migration planning
Tools: Figma, Token Studio, Style Dictionary, Storybook, Chromatic, GitHub, ESLint
Front-end alignment: MUI, Vuetify, Sass, HTML, CSS, JavaScript
Product design: Product architecture, complex workflows, interaction design, visual design
Research: Customer interviews, structured user testing, synthesis, Jobs to Be Done
Collaboration: Engineering alignment, distributed teams, cross-functional facilitation, stakeholder presentations
Languages: Catalan and Spanish (native), English (professional)

EDUCATION

Higher National Diploma in Computing Design and Multimedia

ESI (Escuela de Sistemas Informáticos)

2002